INCOMING TELEGRAM

Department of State

TELEGRAPH BRANCH
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Action

Control: 1258
Rec'd: August 3, 1950
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Info

FROM: Taipei

TO: Secretary of State

NO: 180, August 3, 2 p.m.

No reply received yet from Foreign Office on my inquiry made July 31. in accord with DEPTEL 95, July 31.

At time my guess was that either Chinese Government beginning withdrawal from Chinmen and attack was made to discourage Communist efforts to intervene, or Chinese Government decided make test case to see how far US Government prepared to go in face Chinese Government defiance. Is noteworthy that event occurred and announcement made 2 days after Generalissimo learned of MacArthur intention visit Formosa.

In discussion with Attaches this morning they expressed opinion that attack and announcement of it was deliberate test case. Air Attache states he recently learned CAF has been carrying out other bombing and strafing missions on mainland which have been kept secret.

I am of opinion Chinese Government believes can defy Washington.

Shall request Foreign Minister this afternoon to expedite reply to my inquiry.

STRONG

JAK:CEY

Note: DEPTEL 95 drafted by FE:CA, Clubb.

DECLASSIFIED
E.O. 12065, Sec. 3-402
State Dept. Guideline, June 12, 1979
By NLT-[illegible] NARS, Date 9-22-81

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